

mander Neil Armstrong, Command Module Pilot Michael Collins and Lunar Module Pilot Edwin “Buzz” Aldrin into an initial Earth-orbit of 186 kilometres. The Command and Service Module of the spacecraft was codenamed



Astronauts (left to right) Neil Armstrong, Michael Collins and Edwin “Buzz” Aldrin pose before the launch

Columbia, while the Lunar Module was called ‘Eagle’.

Two hours, 44 minutes and one-and-a-half revolutions after launch, they reignited for a second burn to place the spacecraft into a trans-lunar orbit.

The first colour TV transmission to Earth from Apollo

11 occurred during the translunar coast of the CSM/LM. Later, on July 17, a three-second burn of the SPS was made to perform the second of four scheduled midcourse corrections programmed for the flight. The launch had been so successful that the other three were not needed.

On July 18, Armstrong and Aldrin put on their spacesuits and climbed through the docking tunnel from Columbia to Eagle to check out the LM, and to make the second TV transmission.

On July 19, after Apollo 11 had flown behind the moon out of contact with Earth, they performed lunar orbit insertion manoeuvres that put them in a closer elliptical orbit of the moon at 111 kilometres to 300 kilometres from the surface.

On July 20, Armstrong and Aldrin entered the Lunar Module again, made a final check, and at 100 hours, 12 minutes into the flight, the Eagle undocked and separated from Columbia.

The Eagle

The Lunar Module was a two-stage vehicle designed for space operations near and on the Moon. The spacecraft mass of 15,065 kg was the mass of the LM including astronauts, propellants and expendables.

The Eagle was divided into two parts: the ascent stage and the descent stage. Basically, the two units would go to the moon together as one device, but only the